Git and GitHub for social science research – setting up GitHub Desktop

Step 1. Create a GitHub account

Already have an account? Sign in at http://github.com/login and go to Step 2

Go to https://github.com/signup and sign up. Things to consider:

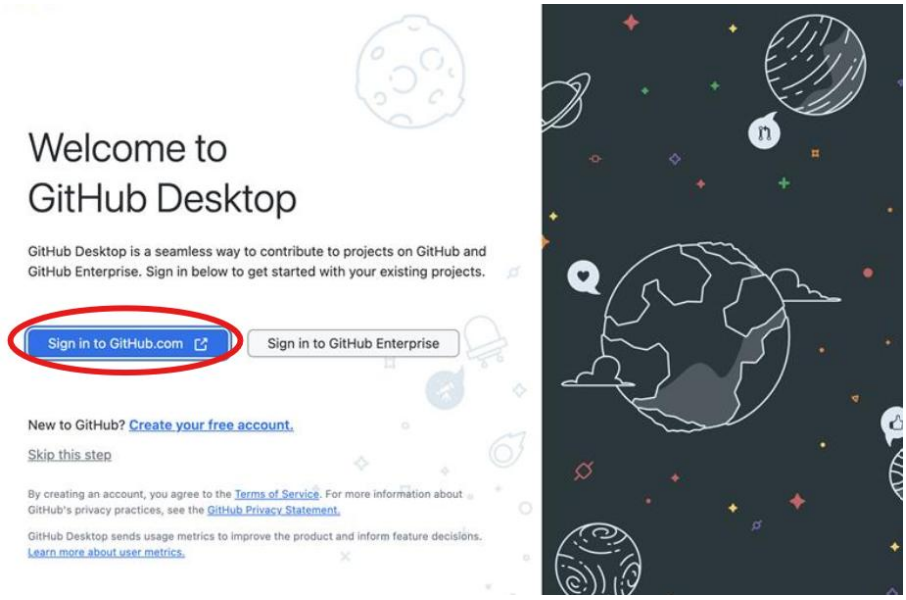
- Choose an email address that you keep after your current position, a gmail address for example
- Your username will be visible to others

Step 2. Download and install GitHub Desktop

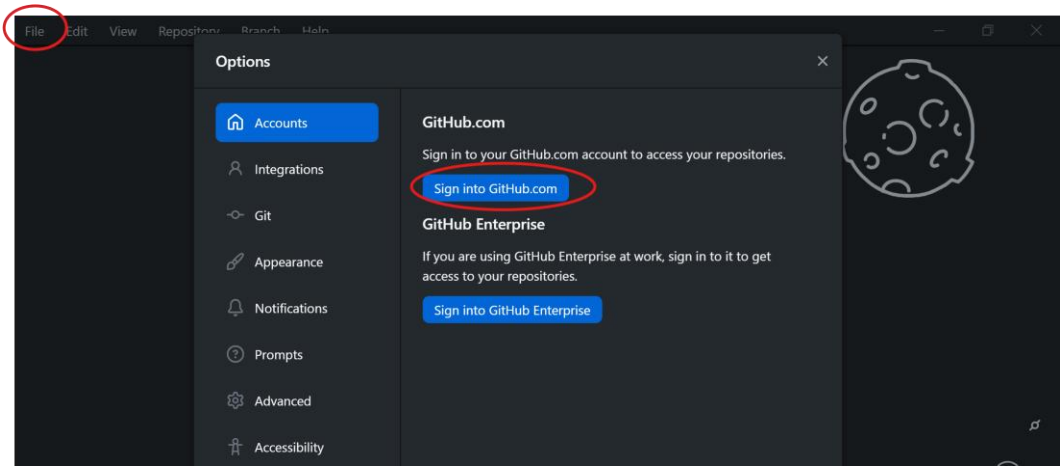
Go to https://desktop.github.com/download/ and download the version for your operating system (Windows or macOS). Click on the downloaded file to finish th installation.

Step 3. Sign in to GitHub in GitHub Desktop

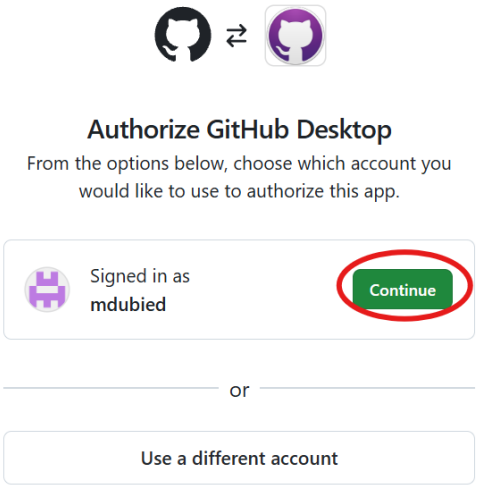
With GitHub Desktop open, click on "Sign into GitHub.com"



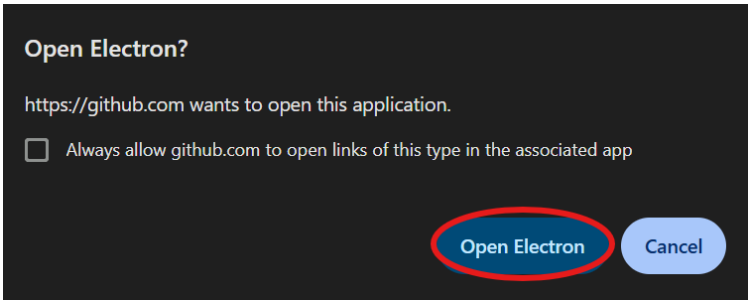
OR, if you don't see this option, click on "File", "Options...", and "Sign into GitHub.com" :



- The webpage opens. As you are already logged in (Step 1), click on "Continue" to authorize GitHub Desktop to use your GitHub account:

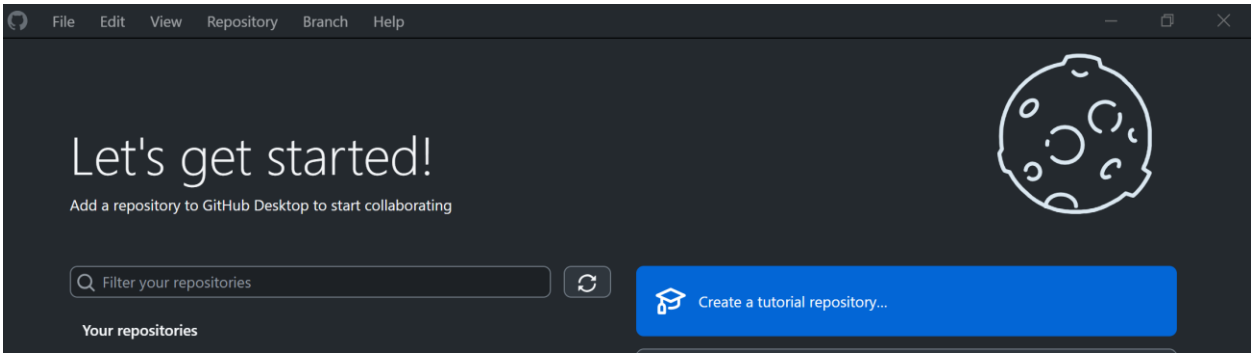


- If the browser open a windows "Open Electron", Click "Open Electron". It will lead you back to GitHub Desktop



All set!

You're all set. GitHub Desktop should look like this:



If you face a screen saying “Configure Git” during the process, check that your name is spelled correctly and click "Finish".

Optional. Install Git for the command line, RStudio or VS Code

You do not need this for the course. If you later want to use Git from the command line, RStudio, or VS Code, install Git separately from https://git-scm.com/install/. You can keep all the recommended settings shown during the installation process.